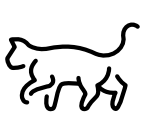
LIVING THINGS

Living and Non-Living Things

What living things do, and sorting living things into groups



cat



deciduous tree



rock



chair

In this pack

- **Learn it:** Living or not living? ★☆☆
- **Fact check:** Sort them out ★☆☆
- **Think it through:** Tricky ones ★★☆
- **Investigate:** Living things in our school ★★☆
- **Real-world case study:** A day at the village pond ★★★
- **Review and challenge:** Show what you know ★★★

This pack belongs to: _____ **Class:** _____

© InquiryMind · Learn · Play · Wonder · Free resources for everyone, bringing quality and equity to education and helping teachers build concepts and make learning visible · Illustrations drawn for InquiryMind · Pictures from OpenMoji (openmoji.org), CC BY-SA 4.0 · Print in black and white on A4 · Challenge: ★ core ★★ deeper ★★★ stretch

LEARN IT · A2 · LIVING AND NON-LIVING

Living or not living?

★☆☆ Grade 2

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Tell the difference between living and non-living things.
- Sort living things into groups and explain why.

Look around you. A cat, a tree and your friend are **living**. A chair, a stone and a pencil are **non-living**. How can we tell?

What do living things do?

Living things...	Example
move	a fish swims; a sunflower turns to the Sun
breathe	we breathe in air
feed (need food and water)	a goat eats grass; a plant makes its own food
grow	a kitten grows into a cat
get rid of waste	animals do poo and wee
sense things around them	a dog hears its name
have young (reproduce)	a hen lays eggs; a mango tree makes seeds

A **living** thing does **all** of these things. A **non-living** thing does not. Some non-living things were **once alive**, like wood from a tree or a dry leaf.


living


living


living


non-living


non-living


once alive

Remember

A car moves and needs fuel, but it does not grow or have baby cars! So it is **non-living**.

Sorting living things

Scientists **sort** living things into groups by looking at their features. We can sort them into **plants** and **animals**, and then sort animals again: animals with **legs** and animals without legs, animals with **fur**, **feathers** or **scales**, animals that **fly**, **swim** or **walk**.

					
feathers	fur	scales	scales	wings	no legs

Bangladesh connection

In the Sundarbans you can find many living things: tigers, deer, crabs, fish, mangrove trees and birds.

Key words

living	moves, breathes, feeds, grows, has young
non-living	not alive and never was, or no longer alive
sort	put into groups
feature	something you can see, like fur or wings

FACT CHECK · A2 · LIVING AND NON-LIVING

Sort them out

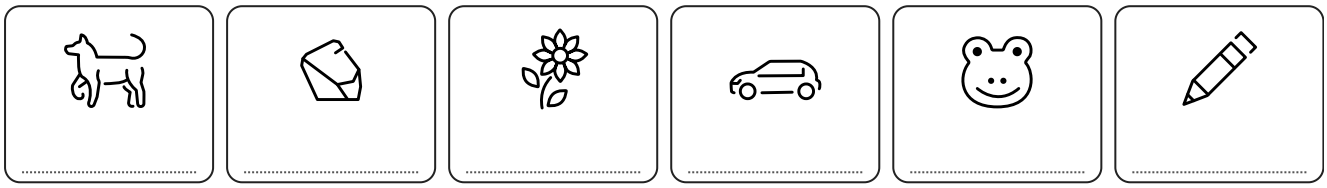
★☆☆ Grade 2

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Sort living and non-living things.

1 Write living or non-living under each picture. [6]



2 Sort these things. [6]

SORT THESE

baby tree ball spoon ant water

Living	Non-living

3 True or false? [3]

Statement	True	False	If false, correct it
1. All living things grow.			
2. A stone can have babies.			
3. Plants are living things.			

THINK IT THROUGH · A2 · LIVING AND NON-LIVING

Tricky ones

★★☆
Grade 2

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Explain why something is living or not.
- Sort animals by features.

1 **A toy robot can move and make sounds. Is it living? Explain.** [2]

2 **Is a seed living? Explain.** [2]

3 **Sort the animals by what covers their body.** [6]

SORT THESE

goat cat parrot snake duck fish

Fur	Feathers	Scales

INVESTIGATE · A2 · LIVING AND NON-LIVING

Living things in our school

★★☆ Grade 2

Name: Class: Date:

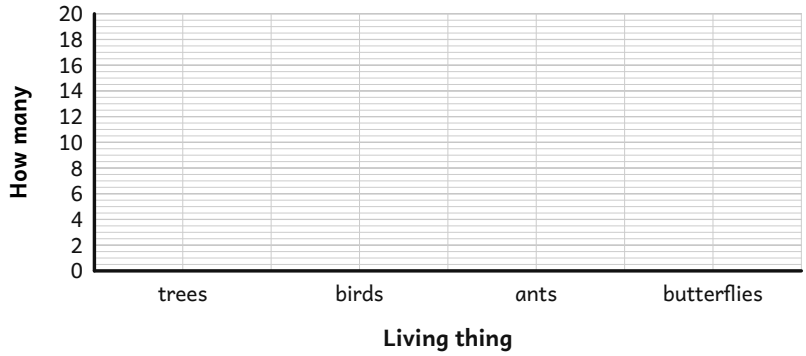
Learning goals

- Count and record.
- Make a pictogram.

Class 2C walked around the school garden and counted the living things they saw.

1 **Draw a bar chart.** [3]

Living thing	trees	birds	ants	butterflies
How many	5	8	20	3



2 **Which living thing did they see most?** [1]

3 **Name two non-living things they might see in the garden.** [2]

REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY · A2 · LIVING AND NON-LIVING

A day at the village pond

★★★
Grade 2

Name: **Class:** **Date:**

Learning goals

- Find living and non-living things in a real place.

Science | Nature | Art

Tanvir visits his grandmother in the village. Behind her house there is a pond. Ducks swim on the water and lotus flowers float on top. Small fish dart under the water. A frog jumps from a lily pad. On the bank there are stones, an old boat and a tree.

Tanvir sits very still and watches. He sees a kingfisher dive and catch a fish!

A story about a village pond.

1 Find the living and non-living things in the story. [7]

SORT THESE

water **frog** **lotus** **ducks** **old boat** **fish** **stones**

Living	Non-living

2 Draw the pond. Draw two living and two non-living things. [2]

The pond

Show what you know

★★★
Grade 2

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Use science words.

1 Find the words.

E	M	P	L	A	N	T	C
I	M	G	F	J	R	C	C
I	H	O	R	E	J	S	F
Y	N	D	V	O	E	V	I
N	Y	D	N	E	W	D	V
S	A	N	I	M	A	L	A
C	N	L	K	M	D	C	I
L	I	V	I	N	G	H	G

animal feed grow living move plant

2 Which is living? [1]

◯ a chair ◯ a cat

◯ a stone

3 Which do all living things do? [1]

◯ fly ◯ grow

◯ swim

4 Challenge. Write three ways you know that you are living. [3]

.....

.....

.....

How am I doing? Colour or tick a circle.

I can...	Not yet	Nearly	Got it!
say what living things do	○	○	○
sort living and non-living things	○	○	○
sort animals by their features	○	○	○
count living things and make a chart	○	○	○